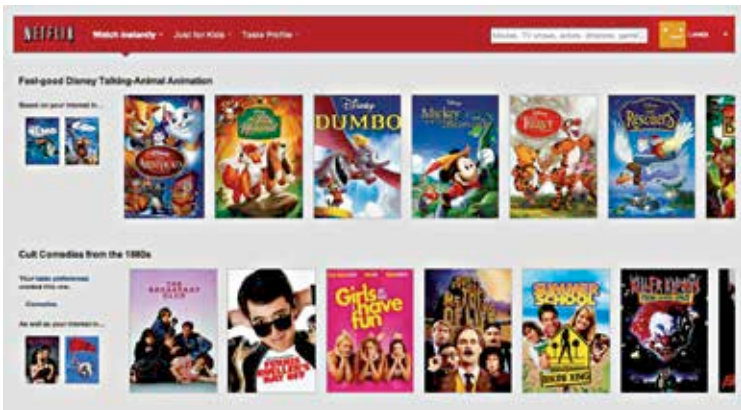


all that separated one team from another and \$1 Million from zilch, it gives a magnificent indicator of the kind of competition that existed between the various groups at the time.

The new algorithm

However, the current Netflix recommendation system no longer uses the same algorithm. This is mostly because of Netflix's diversification into an online streaming service rather than the DVD rental service of the 2000's. Overall ratings are no longer the chief concern and the priority has shifted to personalised rankings and page optimisation. So, how does Netflix do it?



A few extremely specific Netflix categories

The current ranking system focuses on ensuring similarity of movies through an extremely selective categorization of genres while still trying to integrate diversity in an active manner, with the users' awareness. Therefore, the system actively 'learns' from the users choices and offers a customized experience. This explains why, apart from generic genres like Comedy and Drama, one is also likely to find categories like 'Teenage fantasy movies from the 2000's' instead of just 'Fantasy', if the user has a history of rating movies like Harry Potter highly. After such customization is made and specific categories are identified, the Netflix algorithm uses a variation of the Belkor algorithm to offer a list of top ranked movies. However, these top ranked movies are no longer based on a generic global system; they are top ranked movies as rated by users with similar tastes and preferences.